

Genesis 18

“This Is Your Moment: God's Timing Is Still On Time”

Part 1: God’s Promise Still Stands (5 minutes)

- **Genesis 17:21** — “*At this time next year, Sarah will have a son.*”
 - Sarah’s 90 years of barrenness will meet 9 months of divine fulfillment.
 - What God said is time-stamped — within 3 months, she *must* conceive.

Application:

“*Can’t nobody do what God ordained you to do.*”

What’s meant for you won’t come through someone else. Your promise has your name on it. Don’t try to shortcut the process.

- Sarah tried with Hagar — but Ishmael wasn’t the promise.
- Stay in faith. Don’t give up just because it hasn’t happened yet.

Declaration:

“God will do in 12 months what I couldn’t do in the last ____ years. My latter will be greater than my former.”

Part 2: The Power of 99 (5 minutes)

In the last chapter, it mentions that Abram is 99 years old...What happens in Gen 18 is just a short time after that encounter in chapter 17 where Abram is told about the mark of circumcision as a sign of the covenant.

Let me show you something about the number 99.

Counting to 100 for the ancient semitic people was about as far as the average person could go.

there was something psychological about the number 100 to their minds.

Remember the parable of the 99 sheep in Luke 15: 3-7?

100 sheep was the threshold to being rich.

With 99 sheep, you were not yet rich... but 100 put you in the next tax bracket.

Thus, it was a psychological blow to a shepherd who lost one sheep from his 100 fold. If his number dropped below 100 to 99, the shepherd would feel incomplete.

99 left a person wanting, feeling unfulfilled and desiring more.

The Hebrew words for 99 come from a Hebrew root word meaning “a moment in time” or “a pause before the next event!”

Abraham was in the age of life where you would settle back and look forward to retirement. And God shows up and says hey Abraham... this is just a moment in time... Get ready for the next event in your life! It's going to blow your mind!

Notice that by chapter 17: 17 Abraham is 100 years old... did it take a full year to have this conversation that guard started in 17: 1 with him being 99?

100 is considered the number of completion.

In 17: 1 Abraham is telling God hey I am all done... I'm finished and ready to join and God goes... no, you are not finished you are only 99 and I say you will be 100 and reach completion. I am expecting good things from you. There is something else I need you to complete.

- **XTRA NOTES.**
- Abraham was **99** when God gave the promise — a number symbolizing **incompleteness**.
 - 100 was “complete” in ancient thought.
 - **99** = *A moment in time... a pause before the next event.*
 - God wasn't done with Abraham. He was waiting for humility and divine completeness.

Illustration:

- Like the 99 sheep in Luke 15 — close, but something is still missing.
- God wanted Abraham in a posture of surrender *before* fulfillment.

Key Point:

Sometimes delay isn't punishment — it's preparation.

Part 3: God Comes to Your Tent (10 minutes)

Genesis 18:1-2

- The LORD appears at Mamre under the oaks. This isn't random.
 - This is the **same place** where Abraham built an altar (Gen 13:18).

he first mention of this tree is in Genesis 13:18: Abraham moved to **Mamre** when he came back into the promised land from Egypt and built an altar there ([Genesis 13:18](#)) The construction of an altar signifies Abram's devotion and commitment to God, establishing the site as a place of divine encounter.

[Genesis 14:13](#) : It's mentioned again when a fugitive of the war of the 4 kings fighting against 5 other kings and the news that LOT has been captured....so apparently Abram stayed there some time ([Genesis 14:13](#)).

And now its mentioned a third time here in 18:1

The terebinth trees of Mamre: Abraham purchased a field and cave at **Mamre**, using it for Sarah's burial ([Genesis 23:17-19](#)).

Abraham himself was buried there ([Genesis 25:9](#)), and his son Isaac was also buried there ([Genesis 49:30](#), [50:13](#)).

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- God returns to where Abraham worshiped.

Christophany:

- 3 visitors — this is the pre-incarnate Christ appearing again.
- Abraham **runs** to them — uncommon behavior that shows desperation.
- Abraham knows they've arrived ON PURPOSE. His tent is their destination!
- - He begs them to stay. "Don't pass me by."
 - He prepares an **excessive feast** — 50 lbs of flour, a whole calf, curds, milk.
 - 50 lbs of flour that's enough to feed 100 people and that's what Abraham wants to prepare for these three men.
 - Calf. They weigh about 400 lbs so that means about 150 to 400 lbs of meat. Think about it if you eat a 12 ounce or 16 ounce steak that's very filling and you're good. But we're talking about 150 to 400 of these so they basically have enough meat to feed 100 people.
 - verse 8 he took curds and milk and the calf which he had prepared and set it before the men and he stood beside them under the tree while they ate.
 - He took curds and milkthat takes a lot of time to prepare in a warm climate like that. They take 5 or 6 hours to prepare. Curds is how you make cheese.

- And then Abraham just goes over and stands by the tree as these three men are served all this food. He sends his servants away and he becomes the waiter.
- Notice he is standing by that tree and it's the very tree where God gave him the first promise. He standing there hoping that the Lord remembers that right here after Lot left you came and you said that you were going to do all these things for me and remember I built an altar over there when you gave me that promise... like it's right over there. He's saying I'm ready. Don't leave. Give it to me. What's it going to be?
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Why so much?

He doesn't want God to leave. He wants Him to linger.

This is **Abraham's faith response**: extravagant hospitality that creates **space for the promise to be fulfilled**.

Application:

- Make room in your life for God to show up.
- Worship sets the table. Faith invites God to stay.

Part 4: The Moment Sarah is Seen (10 minutes)

Genesis 18:9

And the next words out of the Lord's mouth is after he has prepared and given this huge feast is... where is Sarah your wife.

- God says: "*Where is Sarah your wife?*"
 - She's in the tent — hidden, eavesdropping, full of shame.
 - She's waited for decades, endured shame, tried to make it happen her way, and failed.

But God asks for her.

- The One who never spoke directly to her before now *calls her by name*.
- She's not disqualified. She's not forgotten.

Application:

You may feel unseen or disqualified because of past decisions — but God knows your name and still intends to fulfill His promise **through you**.

Quote:

"The truest thing someone says about you is what you overhear when they don't know you're listening."

Sarah *overhears* God saying her name. That was her moment of hope.

Where is the Princess?

Where is the lady from whom kings shall come.

This is Sarah's reality.

She got the promise from God at 65 years old .
she's endured decades of shame that she was barren.
God asked them to leave everything and go to a land that he was going to show them. She grew up in polygamy where her mom was not the primary wife.

Years go by and nothing is happening for her to overcome her bareness.

So she thinks she's the problem
and she gives Hagar to Abraham
and when she does Abraham does not fight for her
doesn't defend her

doesn't insist on staying faithful to her
he's like OK that sounds good
and Hagar gets pregnant
and Abraham falls in love with this boy.

And when Hagar runs away because Sarah mistreated her

God shows up and gives her a promise
but he's never spoken anything directly to Sarah.

But he shows up and tells Hagar that Ishmael's going to have a great nation
and all of these great things are going to come from him

and Hagar names God the God who sees me
and she comes back to Sarah and Abraham

and tells Abraham all these things
and Sarah is taking this all in
and thinking he has never appeared to me
and I don't feel heard.

I don't feel seen.

Maybe the promise is passing me by.

She's increasingly isolated and she's in this tent listening through the tent door and she hears God ask for her.

Sarah probably feels disqualified and feels like she is outside of the love of God.

She probably feels like she's outside of the covenant.

That she has no right to claim anything
and here is God showing up to Abraham
and saying thank you for the meal

but where's your wife... She's the one we're looking for.

Remember she's the fourth woman mentioned in the Bible and she's the first woman in the line of Seth.

Someone once said that the most trustworthy thing that someone says about you is what you overhear them say when they don't know you are listening.

If they tell it to you to your face then that might be flattery but if they tell it to someone else then you're not there then it is a trustworthy thing.

Verse 10 notice what God says to Abraham and to Sarah.
She's in the tent but he's talking to her and to Abraham... I will surely return to you at this time next year and behold Sarah your wife will have a son.

And Sarah was listening at the tent door which was behind him.

Now the English does not pull out what is pretty cool about this.

The word " about this time next year" is actually the meaning when things come to life again. It's talking about spring. It's when the time of reviving comes. I'm coming to you this time when everything is brought back to life.

Why is this significant? Because that's her womb right now.

It's literally a picture of resurrection.

The dead season is about to pass I will bring about a life to you when the time of reviving comes. God is all about resurrection here.

Now you would think that Sarah's heart would explode with joy. Right? And with gratitude.

Instead it says in the very next verse now Abraham and Sarah were old, well advanced in years; She was past the age of childbearing. That's verse 11

genesis really wants you to remember that. Moses is writing this book and so it's like every chance he has he's reminding us they're really old.

So "the way of women has ceased to be with Sarah" this means she's postmenopausal.

And in verse 12 it says **Sarah laughed to herself** when she heard the Lord's words saying after I had become old shall I have pleasure and delight, my lord (husband) being also old

Now in Romans 4:19... it talks about when Abraham brings about Isaac, that it was partly miraculous because his body was as good as dead.

It's no longer just Sarah who's barren... it's no longer just Sarah's body that's no longer capable of producing children. Abraham's not able to participate anymore either.

The word shall I have pleasure... the word pleasure is the Hebrew word that comes from the root word Eden. And it's literally means can you restore everything that was beautiful and wonderful?

Then verse 13 says... and the Lord asked Abraham why did Sarah laugh to herself saying shall I really give birth to a child when I am so old?

And the word there for laughter is like mocking. She's basically saying this is ridiculous. And hang on to that word because in a couple of chapters when Ismael's going to be sent away, the word is going to be mocking... and it's the same word as laughter. That word has a big deal to play in the story. So she laughs at God and the Lord said to Abraham why did Sarah laugh?

Notice he asked Abraham that. He's asking how is it that your wife feels so forsaken and so cut out of the promises that I've given you? Haven't you assured her? Haven't you shared the promises with her? Have you not comforted her?

And then all of a sudden Sarah speaks up and says I didn't laugh, for she was afraid. In verse 15. And God says no, you did laugh.

But the verse says she laughed to herself... So what does that tell is ... all of a sudden Sarah knows that she can't have a private thought from God. He knows where her heart is.

Hebrews 4:12. For the word of God is living and powerful and sharper than any two edged sword... And is a designer of the thoughts and intents of the heart.

She's probably thinking what else has he heard over the last 24 years of bitterness and grumbling and anger at God and feeling betrayed? And here he is still chasing me. This shows the relentless and Amazing Grace of God.

She is mocking in her heart at him he is like I want to know her.

why is she doing this Abraham? Like, why does she not feel precious? Why have you failed in this?

God is showing he's concerned about her heart even as internally she's mocking him or at least laughing at the promise. It's pretty amazing. God is

protecting her in this. God is showing up on her side and asking Abraham to bring her along.

He has failed miserably at this because back in genesis 12 when he lied to pharaoh about her God had to show up to rescue for the end. But because God doesn't move on her timetable she feels forsaken.

But yet God is relentless. He does not give up on her.

And he is showing her that he knows what's going on inside of her... she's behind the tent door. She didn't laugh out loud. She laughed on the inside so that means that God knows what's going on inside of me. This means he knows all the parts that are broken or barren or whatever. He's sovereign. He can see far more than I want to give him credit for.

God loves Sarah more than Abraham does.
He cares about Ishmael more than Abraham does.
He cares about Isaac more than Abraham does.

And he does the same for us. When we're making a mess out of our lives and out of our relationships he's patient to keep pursuing us. He just keeps chasing after his people and bringing beautiful things even out of our own stupidity. That's what you see in this story. You can look at Abraham and Sarah and Hagar and go “what a hot mess” right? And yet God is in the midst of it. Faithful as can be, beautiful as can be, filling in all the gaps. And making it all beautiful.

And there's a comfort in that. God's going to fill in all the gaps and he's going to bring light out of the darkness. He's a good God! Amen?

Closing Challenge & Prayer (Optional 2–3 minutes if time allows)

- Encourage each listener:
 - You are not too old, too late, too broken, or too far gone.
 - Don't dismiss the moment just before breakthrough.
 - God sees you. God remembers what He promised. **Stay faithful.**

Call to Action:

“This is my moment. I will not miss my promise. God is not passing me by.”

Pray for renewed faith, patience in the waiting, and personal revelation of God's presence and purpose.

